



THE BEGINNINGS



This is a history of Iron Arrow, “the highest honor attained by men” at the University of Miami. Like any growing, living thing, its history has been profoundly influenced by the seeds from which it has sprung. And the society we see today has drawn its substance and strength from the soil in which those seeds are rooted. The climate in which it has grown has left its record, too. The lean years and the bountiful years can still be traced, as can the scars that have covered old wounds from battles almost forgotten. All these things are stories in themselves.

How shall this history begin? How else could a history of Iron Arrow begin than with the stories of the two men whose legends are bound inextricably into the tradition of our tribe: the Seminole warrior whose name, Osceola (Asiyaholo), means “the black-drink singer” and the man who founded both our University and our tribe, Bowman Foster Ashe.





OSCEOLA

There hangs in the Smithsonian Institution in Washington, D.C., a haunting, Christlike portrait of the Indian, Osceola, which was painted by the frontier artist George Catlin in 1838. The dark, subdued, and muted colors with which Catlin recorded the warrior reflect not the bright, glaring intensity of a Florida sun or the dancing shadows and light of a council fire. They reflect, instead, the somber colors of the prison at Fort Moultrie in Charleston, South Carolina, where Osceola died only a few days after Catlin rendered the portrait.

The Florida rainy season had not yet arrived in April 1835. The room was hot and crowded. The soldiers and Indians who had gathered there were tense and uncomfortable. Between the two groups stood a rough-hewn table, a document “affirming” the 1833 Treaty of Payne’s Landing and centuries.

The longhand scrawl proposed to uproot an entire Indian culture from the Florida substrate on which it flourished and remove it west to Oklahoma. General Wiley Thompson, his command, and the United States Government stood behind the document. Eight chiefs stepped to the table to make their marks. But as the roll continued, Micanopy, Jumper, Alligator, and Arpeika shook their heads or “sat or stood like stone.”¹ “Osceola,” came the call. Like the thud of a horse’s hoof, the answer came: quivering from the violence of the movement, Osceola’s knife stood alone where he had plunged it into the paper, pinning it against the wood of the table.

Osceola’s reply was prophetic; for although many Indians finally agreed to go west, those who stayed behind were never conquered. And more than a



¹ Douglas, Marjory Stoneman, *The Everglades, River of Grass*. (Iron Arrow, 1986, and former member of the UM faculty.)





century passed before the white man's civilization began to do that which his armies had been unable to do: subdue the Everglades and its Indians. But that year was 1835, and it marked the beginning of the Second Seminole War.

If Osceola's dramatic defiance of the United States on behalf of his people was not enough to certify his place in history, then the manner of his capture by his enemies was certain to do so. On October 21, 1837, General Joseph M. Hernandez, on orders from General Thomas J. Jesup, rode with an escort of 200 mounted men to meet with Osceola, as the Indian warrior had requested. Beneath the flag of truce, Osceola informed Hernandez that the Indians "wished to make peace, but had not agreed to emigration."² Hernandez, however, had been instructed to take the Indians captive if their replies were "unsatisfactory."³ Consequently, at the General's signal, his troops "swooped into the camp and surrounded the Indians, capturing . . . the entire Indian party, numbering 12 important chiefs, 71 warriors, six women, and four Negroes..."⁴ The prisoners were then escorted to St. Augustine and imprisoned briefly at Fort Marion, the old Spanish fortress known today as Castillo San Marcos. When the capture was reported in American newspapers, scores of editorials were written condemning the treachery, but the prisoners were never released.

In late December of 1837, Jesup shipped all of the captives, including Osceola, to Fort Moultrie at Charleston, South Carolina. By the time Catlin arrived in late January to paint Osceola's portrait, the chief was already severely ill with an attack of malaria and a putrid sore throat. Catlin noted after rendering the portrait that he did not think the chief would live through the night.⁵ Death and martyrdom did not come for several days, however.

When death did come, on January 30, 1838, Dr. Frederick Weedon, the post surgeon, recorded the following eyewitness' description:

About half an hour before he died, he seemed to be sensible that he was dying. Although he could not speak, he signified by signs that he wished me to send for the chiefs and for the officers of the Post, whom I called in. He made signs to his wives (of whom he had two, and also two fine little children by his side) to go and bring his full dress, which he wore in time of war; which having been brought in, he rose up in his bed, which was on the floor, and put on his shirt, his leggings and his moccasins - girded on his war-belt - his bullet pouch and powder-horn, and laid his knife by the side of him on the floor. He then called for his red paint, and his looking-glass, which was held before him, when he painted one-half of his face, his neck

² Josephy, Jr., Alvin M., *The Patriot Chiefs*.

³ *Ibid.*

⁴ *Ibid.*

⁵ *Ibid.*





and throat, his wrists, the backs of his hands, and the handle of his knife, red with vermillion: a custom practiced when the irrevocable oath of war and destruction is taken. His knife he then placed in its sheath, under his belt and he carefully arranged his turban on his head and his three Ostrich plumes that he was accustomed to wearing in it. Being thus prepared in full dress, he laid down a few minutes to recover sufficient strength, when he rose up as before, and with most benign and pleasing smiles, extended his hand to me and to all the officers and chiefs that were around him: and shook hands with us all in dead silence; and also with his wives and little children; he made a signal for them to lower him down upon his bed, which was done, and he then slowly drew from his war-belt his scalping knife, which he firmly grasped in his right hand, laying it across the other on his breast, and a moment later smiled away his last breath without a struggle or a groan.⁶

On April 18, 1906, earthquake and fire struck San Francisco, California. A few months later, somewhere in the High Sierras to the east of the city, a young man reined his horse and peered into the morning fog. Now that he was near the camp, the young man could smell the wood smoke and bacon in the crisp, chilly air. His name was Bowman Ashe. He was paymaster for the Union



⁶Weedon, Dr. Frederick, as quoted by Josephy, *The Patriot Chiefs*.





BOWMAN FOSTER ASHE

Construction Company. Thirty miles from the nearest mountain towns, it took him four days by horseback to make the rounds of the nine construction camps.⁷

Born on April 3, 1885, in Scottsdale, Pennsylvania, Bowman Ashe was one of six sons of a Methodist minister, he was in California after three years of schooling at Mt. Union College, and besides his employ as a paymaster in the Sierra Nevada, he taught in a small, rural school. He graduated from the University of Pittsburgh in 1912, and was named Dean of Men and University Examiner there in 1918.⁸

When Pitt allowed him a leave of absence in 1925 and he came to Miami, they lost him for good. On March 18, 1926, he was named Executive Secretary of the University of Miami, a new school that was scheduled to open its doors for the first time that fall. A half-year later, on November 3, he was appointed to the position he would hold until his death: President of the University of Miami. The rest is legend.

The disastrous hurricane of September 17 and 18, 1926, toppled the rosy dreams before they had begun and the fledgling UM opened its doors, late, in an unfinished hotel with cardboard walls. The palatial Spanish campus that had been planned had literally “gone with the wind” as the Florida land boom collapsed. On Friday, October 15, 1926, the University of Miami opened its doors with a \$5 million debt. It was in this crucible that the Ashe legend was forged. In the beginning, Dr. and Mrs. Ashe lived in the University dormitories among their students. The famous mansion on Bayshore Drive in Coconut Grove, that would later become the home of the Ashes, the Pearsons, and the Stanfords had not yet been given to the University by its owner, W. T. Grant. Even the privacy of the family dinner could not be afforded the young president. Since the dormitories in which they lived contained no kitchen facilities, the Ashe family took their meals each day in the University cafeteria.⁹

If the University was in debt when it opened in 1926, the Great Depression was waiting in the wings only three years away to send it to an early grave. This was not to be, however. “To keep the University running, Dr. Ashe borrowed on his personal insurance policy to pay professors’ salaries.”¹⁰ This generosity permeated every facet of Ashe’s association with his school. One Iron Arrow member reports that Dr. Ashe lent students his own car to drive up to Chattanooga to a football game. The same source reports that Dr. Ashe paid for the Iron Arrow page in the Ibis in those times of tin-can tourists and breadlines. In the same spirit, the founder of the society hosted a luncheon party in the dining room of

⁷The University of Miami - The First Twenty-Five Years.

⁸The Miami Hurricane, November 6, 1959.

⁹Beery, John, Eulogy for Marie Rose Ashe, March 1, 1975





what is now called the San Sebastian Apartments on University Drive in Coral Gables, to honor the new tappees each year after they were initiated.¹¹

If the times imposed burdens beyond bearing, they also etched the character of the men who bore them. As was said in a speech rededicating the Ashe Administration Building on November 12, 1970, “not much remained except B.F. Ashe, but he proved to be all that was needed. We are here because of him; his struggle is Miami’s legacy; this University is his shadow.”¹²

John McGuire, a founding member of Iron Arrow, recalled that which most impressed him about Dr. Ashe and the UM back then: It was the “belief that you could start with nothing and come up with something.” As students commonly did during those times, John and his roommates worked part-time at the University to help pay their college bills. On more than one occasion, as they swept the wooden hallways on the upper floors of the old Anastasia Building, Dr. Ashe would happen upon them at their work. Stopping, the President would empty a wastebasket and, turning it upside down, use it as a seat for himself as the three of them would sit and discuss the University’s future.

McGuire said, “Iron Arrow was his pet and pride. He wanted the University to be local in character, and he chose the Spanish influence for its architecture and the Indian influence for its honor society.”¹³

Harold J. Humm remembered that Dr. Ashe “often spoke of Iron Arrow on occasions when he addressed the student body. He once said, ‘we were Miami’s Phi Beta Kappa, but much more.’ He was always flattering and encouraging and he enhanced the distinction of election to Iron Arrow a great deal.”¹⁴ Francis Houghtaling’s recollection was similar. “Iron Arrow was just another brick, or maybe it was the cement as Dr. Ashe would have called it, to the accomplishment of building the University of Miami.”¹⁵

Once the tribe was firmly established, Dr. Ashe, himself, was initiated according to Seminole custom in a jungle area on the canal just north of the present site of the University.¹⁶ He also personally gave the tribe the “Tower Room” in the old Anastasia Building of the University. The triangular old three-story building surrounded an open courtyard. University, Riviera, and Segovia Drives in Coral Gables bound the lot on which it stood. “We marched down the hall to the stairs of the rotunda and up to our room which was the first balcony four stories up.”¹⁷ The room was always kept locked and the drum could be heard in that room when the tribe was in session. This room, however, was “later broken

¹⁰ The Miami Hurricane, November 6, 1959

¹¹ Koger, James, telephone conversation of January 3, 1976.

¹² Leatherwood, John E., Ashe Building Rededication Address, November 12, 1970.

¹³ McGuire, John, personal interview with author, spring, 1974.

¹⁴ Humm, Harold, letter to the author, December 26, 1974.

¹⁵ Houghtaling, Francis S., letter to the author, October 27, 1974.





into and stuff stolen.” It was Dr. Ashe who appointed Howard Southgate, professor of Drama, to call the first meeting of Iron Arrow.¹⁸

In 1950, Iron Arrow was granted an official University Charter by Dr. Ashe. Iron Arrow is the only student organization ever to be awarded such a document. The charter reads:

“Be it known by these presents that the University of Miami does hereby confirm the granting of a charter to IRON ARROW HONOR SOCIETY, The Highest Honor Attained By Men, founded in 1926 at the University of Miami as an organization of those who excel in scholarship and leadership, with all the rights and privileges of membership provided therefore under the Constitution of the Society.”

The Charter is signed “B. F. Ashe, President”.

Dr. Ashe’s health began to deteriorate in the fall of 1952. In early November, he asked the Board of Trustees to relieve him of his duties. But before they could act on his request, The Miami Hurricane had to report on November 14, 1952, that the President had suffered a “cerebral accident last Friday while lunching at the Columbus Hotel with friends.” Dr. Ashe died on December 16, 1952, in Doctor’s Hospital at the age of 67.

At the inception of Iron Arrow, there was another man whose role was profound. His contributions were cut short by an early death, and the memory of his role was lost to all but those first select members who knew him. His name was Tony Tommie.

He was a member of the Panther Clan of the Seminole Nation. The first hint of his role in Iron Arrow was discovered in a yellowed, brittle newspaper clipping in the UM archives: “the Iron Arrow tribe of the Seminole Nation... has for its Supreme Leader, Tony Tommie, educated Seminole Indian.”¹⁹ Then, in 1934, another article was printed which proved even more tantalizing. “Tony Tommie, the late chief of the Seminoles, made all members of the organization official members of the Seminole Nation.”²⁰

¹⁶ McGuire, John, as above.

¹⁷ Houghtaling, Francis S., letter to the author, February 25, 1975.

¹⁸ Houghtaling, Francis S., letter to the author, October 27, 1974.



TONY TOMMIE

Then, the clinching article was found. Apparently Tony had been invited to a Miami football game as the guest of the UM Athletic Association. The account of his visit read as follows: “What memories will flood the stout old heart of Tony Tommie, chieftain of all the Seminoles, tomorrow as he watches the University of Miami and Southern freshmen battle on the stadium field?

“For far back in the good old days when Jim Thorpe, Carlac, Cyoun, Frank Mt. Pleasant, Chief Lone Ear and all the rest of those famous characters were making football history at Carlisle, Chief Tony Tommie also played his football under the direction of the famous Pop Warner.”²¹

In response to specific queries, bits and pieces of the story began to roll in. Harold J. Humm wrote to say, “No, I can’t say that I knew Chief Tony Tommie. But I remember seeing him more than once when I was in junior high school. He and his associates often shopped along Miami Avenue (the New York Bargain Store, for example), back in the days when the paving was still wooden bricks that floated around after heavy rains. I especially remember Shirttail Charlie who was obliged to follow the tribe a certain distance in the rear for some sort of transgression for which he had been formally convicted.”²²

A major breakthrough came with the recollections of Francis Houghtaling, first student to enroll at the University of Miami and one of the “founding nine” student members of Iron Arrow. “My father came to Miami in 1910. When I came in 1911, Miami had a population of 4,498 according to Polk’s Directory. My father had a real estate office on the south side of the street across from the courthouse - 424 12th Street (now Flagler). (There were originally only 14 streets in the city.) Three stores west of us was a grocery store run by Murray Wiggington’s father where the Seminole Indians congregated and bought their supplies when they came to town. So I was accustomed to them. They all wore their colorful dresses, the men’s came to just below the knee. The women’s length of dress was to the ground. (Only one Indian wore our clothes and that was Willie Willie, a chauffeur for Mrs. McAllister who built the McAllister Hotel. He had the top of one ear cut off because he had stolen a canoe as a youth.)

“The Seminoles, when they came to town, would all parade down through town with all their families and back to the grocery before leaving.... The man would walk in front, next his wife, then the children. They always kept their families together and all went wherever the father went. . . . They would not allow

¹⁹ Updated clipping of unknown origin, Pauline Spofford Scrapbook, c.1927-28, University of Miami archives.

²⁰ The Miami Hurricane, May 11, 1934.

²¹ Updated clipping of unknown origin, Spofford Scrapbook, c. 1927-28, University of Miami archives.

²² Humm, Harold, as above.





their pictures to be taken.

“This was my background as a child which made me want to preserve their colorful and respected nation to Miami and Florida as a part of UM and vice versa.”²³

Along with this background, Houghtaling recounted his memories of Tony Tommie. “Tony Tommie was chief of the Everglades Seminoles in 1926. How far his authority reached in Florida at that time was unknown. I never asked. He had the bearing of one who had it, which precluded anyone to even think of such a question. He was a lawyer.

“He never turned me down to meet with us. When I first met him, I told him that our president, Dr. Ashe, desired a group of outstanding men to be a white tribe or clan of the Seminoles. The selection would become the highest honor given in recognition to those tapped. He understood all this. Never questioned the idea I asked him to come to the University to meet Dr. Ashe and then meet with us.

“He met with us in the tower room. We sat on the floor cross-legged. This first meeting was without shirts but we discussed with him if we could have a tribal color not used by any other tribe and he said orange could be used since it was one of the University colors. We had the first shirts made with orange shoulder yokes. Cost \$5.00 each. ... We finished with all of us smoking the peace pipe.”²⁴

The remaining details about Tony Tommie fell into place from more recent sources. A striking photograph of Tony with his mother Annie Tommie²⁵

²³ Houghtaling, Francis S., a letter to the author, November 4, 1975.





accompanied a piece written by journalist, Bill McGoun, in the early 1970s. The photograph shows a tall, handsome man of large frame. According to the article, Tony Tommie “... was the first Seminole to receive an extensive white man’s education.”²⁶

According to another source. “It was primarily through the exertions of Mrs. Frank Stranahan [of Fort Lauderdale] that Tony Tommie, a Seminole lad of 15, entered the Fort Lauderdale elementary school in 1915.²⁷ The reminiscences of his teachers ... show that Tony was an affable and intelligent youngster who was well liked by the townspeople. He cut a dashing figure in his brightly hued Seminole shirt and long pants (this at a time when schoolboys still wore knickers), and was invariably barefooted even in school. ... “He was a good student,” one teacher recalled, “and he was very anxious to learn and especially did he want to learn how to read and spell After two terms at the public school, Tony Tommie was sent to a federal boarding school for Indians in Oklahoma; upon his return he became the acknowledged leader of the Seminole people in the Fort Lauderdale area.”²⁸

The significance of Tony’s scholastic accomplishments should not be underrated. As McGoun writes “Tony was not the first Seminole to go to school, but he was the first to stay there for long. In the 1880s, Billy Cornpatch was put under a tribal death sentence after attending classes less than 30 days on the Gulf Coast. Reportedly, he escaped execution only by promising not to teach any other Indian how to read or write.”²⁹

According to Harry Kersey’s account, the Indian agent, Reverend Lucien A. Spencer, made the following comments on the implications of Tony’s schooling: “The fact that we have one boy in school by tribal permission is an advance. ... The time is not far distant when the tribal law... providing that persons learning to read and write shall have their ears cropped will be repealed.”³⁰

When I spoke to Mrs. Martha Tiger and George Storm of the Dania village in January of 1975, they indicated that Tony was never a chief in the accepted sense of the word, although he was elected to be a spokesman for the tribe on more than one occasion. Apparently he made at least one trip to Washington to discuss benefits for his people in exchange for a formal end to the Seminole wars. Such actions, however, made him a somewhat controversial figure among

²⁴ Ibid.

²⁵ James Hutchinson has painted a portrait of Annie Tommie as a part of his famous collection of oils on the Seminole Indians now owned by the University Of Miami.

²⁶ McGoun, Bill, “Tony Tommie: Very Few Know Much About Him.” From an updated newspaper clipping of unknown origin.

²⁷ Jim Thorpe played his last year of football at Carlisle in 1912, so the earlier account of Tony’s feats with Thorpe was apparently a glamorization.

²⁸ Kersey, Dr. Harry, Florida Atlantic University, Florida Education in the 70’s, Justin and Kersey, authors.





his own people. As McGoun reports, “Seminole then were still very much of two minds regarding the U.S. government. Some, such as Tony, wanted funds and services which they believed were due the tribe in return for the lands taken during the Seminole Wars.”³¹ Others would only say pahaan checkish (just leave us alone.)

Tony was also controversial because he championed education. It had not been too many years before that Billy Cornpatch had been sentenced to death for learning, and many of Tony’s people had not relinquished that attitude. Nevertheless, it was undoubtedly his interest in education that led him to embrace the concept of Iron Arrow at the University of Miami. As Houghtaling reports, “Tony liked this concept that he’d have a tribe in college: the university.”³²

The year of Tony’s birth is not known, though it is believed to have been between 1896 and 1904. McGoun’s article indicates that “...He was born three weeks after the Green Corn Dance, which was traditionally held in late May or early June....”³³ He was one of seven sons born to Annie Tommie and Doctor. One of his brothers, Brownie, is alive at this writing and lives on the Big Cypress Reservation; while a nephew, Howard Tommie, is chairman of the Seminole Tribe of Florida. Tony never married because of his early death, though he is said to have courted an Indian girl billed as “Princess” at the Musa Isle Village in Miami, where he wrestled alligators. He even played a bit part, one time, in a 1925 movie called *The Ramshackle House*.³⁴ Tony died of tuberculosis on April 6, 1931, in Jackson Memorial Hospital and is buried at the cemetery on the Dania Reservation.

There is a story associated with his burial that must be told. In Longfellow’s epic poem, “The Song of Hiawatha,” the following ritual is recounted:

Four days is the spirit’s journey
To the land of ghosts and shadows,
Four its lonely night encampments;
Four times must their fires be lighted.
Therefore, when the dead are buried,
Let a fire, as night approaches,
Four times on the grave be kindled,
That the soul upon its journey
May not lack the cheerful fire-light,
May not grope about in darkness.³⁵

McGoun’s article indicates that upon Tony’s death, Christian services

²⁹ McGoun, Bill, as above.

³⁰ Spencer, Reverend Lucien A., as quoted in *Florida Education* in the 70’s, Justin and Kersey.

³¹ McGoun, Bill, as above.

³² Houghtaling, Francis S., letter to the author, August 27, 1974.

³³ McGoun, Bill, as above.





were held in the Dania Methodist Church. Afterward, however, "... Tony was buried with his personal effects in traditional Seminole style. According to later accounts, his brother, Ben, dropped three unlit matches, plus the embers of a fourth, into his grave to light his way into the next world."³⁶

Many people, when they first come to Florida, are disappointed with its flat topography. Those who stay soon learn that Florida's towering thunder heads are its mountains and the cool, dark banyan tunnels are its valleys. The Seminole Indian is its tradition. It was in this Eden that Iron Arrow had its genesis.

On a November afternoon in 1926, only one month after UM opened its doors, Dr. Bowman Foster Ashe walked into Dr. O. P. Hart's physics laboratory. He climbed onto a high lab stool next to Francis Houghtaling, who was conducting an experiment, and said "I have talked to Howard Southgate about your idea of a Seminole ritual for a tap society for men."³⁷ As Houghtaling now explains, "I had previously discussed with him this idea of an Indian Ritual for a fraternity which he vetoed and convinced me to save the idea for a better purpose which he would discuss when it was time to initiate it. Now was the time."³⁸

Houghtaling asked Dr. Ashe what a tap society was. Dr. Ashe replied that a tap society was an honor society which selects for membership those men who contribute "to the glory, fame and growth of the UM. Like Blue Key at Gainesville."³⁹

Houghtaling continued, "Dr. Ashe spent some time with me to explain his concept. Such old institutions as Harvard, Yale and Princeton had set a path



³⁴ Ibid.

³⁵ Longfellow, Henry Wadsworth, "The Ghosts," from *The Song of Hiawatha*.

³⁶ McGoun, Bill, as above.





THE IDEA, THE NAME, AND THE FIRST MEETING

like a cow wandering through the woods, which made trails of tradition that could not be changed. Since we were a new University, we could chart our course like a surveyor using a compass and transit to make a straight course, with a shorter path for traditions. This would make a stronger UM to have a chartered course at its inception.

“The name Iron Arrow originated on this principle: The arrow in flight made a straight course so we had arrow which is usually associated with bow but that we discarded. Someone suggested iron because this was the Iron Age and not the Bow & Arrow Age. Then someone else suggested, ‘How about the arrow, instead of being made of wood, be made of Iron. ‘Then all of us exclaimed IRON ARROW !!! That’s it, IRON ARROW!’”⁴⁰

Houghtaling’s account sheds further light on what Dr. Ashe had in mind. The organization was intended to be a junior-senior organization. However, since “we were only a freshman University, normally we would have to wait two years, but he thought if it could be started in ‘26, the founding year of UM, it would start traditions and establish them right at the beginning...”⁴¹

“We were to get Tony Tommie, then chief of the Seminoles, to sponsor us in ritual and shirt design. He said we could use orange on our shoulders, which would denote the University of Miami Tribe. Green was Tigertail. White was Osceola. But no tribe in South Florida had orange, [so] shirts had to be made special.... Tony was a college man and he liked this concept that he’d have a tribe in college.”⁴²

Dr. Ashe appointed Howard Southgate, professor of Drama, to call the first meeting. According to Houghtaling, “I saw Howard Southgate and gave him the list of nine names to be asked to the first meeting. He approved and took them to Dr. Ashe, who in turn told him to go ahead and write a letter to each and invite them to our first I. A. meeting in his office in [the] auditorium. (Later: the East Tower Room). It was agreed with Dr. Ashe and Howard that no one would know I had anything to do with it. Howard was to present ... an honor ‘tap’ society to be ‘the highest honor attained by men’, to be organized at the request of Dr. Ashe.”⁴³

So the first meeting was called by Howard Southgate and held in his office in the auditorium of the old Anastasia Building. This meeting was held

³⁷ Houghtaling, Francis S., a letter to the author, October 27, 1974.

³⁸ Ibid.

³⁹ Ibid.

⁴⁰ Ibid.





sometime in November of 1926, and the name Iron Arrow was chosen. Ashe and Houghtaling had established its basic framework and Indian orientation. It was evidently determined at that meeting to invite Tony Tommie to a subsequent session to discuss jackets and Seminole sponsorship.

The first nine members of Iron Arrow were Leonard Tuttle, Gavin Millar, Clarke Wilson, Francis Houghtaling, John McGuire, Dale Clark, Harry Gray, Bob Fink, and Ted Kennedy.

Leonard Tuttle was the first Chief of Iron Arrow and the following year served as Chief's Eldest Son. At the University, Tuttle was the manager of the undefeated football team, a member of the "M" club, student council and Phi Alpha, now Pi Kappa Alpha. He was also the first business manager of the school's new yearbook, the *Ibis*. Tuttle was famous in Miami, at large, as the "grandson of Julia Tuttle, who influenced Henry M. Flagler to bring the Florida East Coast Railroad into Miami."⁴⁴ Tuttle's father "gave him a large Pierce Arrow limousine or sedan which he used to haul the football squad to and from the football field. He paid for his own gasoline and always had money. The football season was in full swing and Leonard was given credit for holding the team together."⁴⁵ Houghtaling thinks that it was Tuttle who suggested the word "iron" in the naming of the tribe. He also believes Tuttle to have been the one who had the original arrow and small Iron Arrow pins made.

The Chief's Eldest Son that first year was Francis S. Houghtaling. Houghtaling was not only the first student ever to enroll at the University of Miami, but was also the person responsible for the idea of an organization based on the cultures of the American Indian. He was responsible for the naming of the *Ibis* yearbook and served as president of the fraternity, Phi Alpha. He was



⁴¹ Ibid.

⁴² Ibid.

⁴³ Ibid.





THE FOUNDING NINE AND THE PETITION

also assistant basketball manager and the assistant business manager of the year-book. He sold \$100 worth of tickets to the first football game played and put cards announcing each week's games into all the buses and streetcars in Miami. His father was owner and president of Houghtaling Farms, the major distributor of dairy products in Dade County. Francis has remained active in tribal affairs throughout the first 50 years of the organization's existence, including voluminous contributions in the formulation of this history.

Iron Arrow's first Medicine Man was Dale Clark, author of lyrics to a new fight song of the time, "Hail To The Spirit."⁴⁶ Clark was president of the sophomore class, assistant editor of the *Ibis*, and the editor of the University News, precursor of The Miami Hurricane. As Medicine Man, he wrote the first initiation ritual which "had to do" with some noble Seminoles finding a huge arrow made of iron. "What they did with it I don't remember, but they passed over a body of water - probably Lake Okeechobee."⁴⁷

John "McGoogan" McGuire was Medicine Man of Iron Arrow during its second year. He was the star halfback on the only undefeated football team (1926) the University of Miami has ever fielded.⁴⁸ He was the junior-senior representative on the Student Council, the basketball team's high-scorer for the season, an officer of the "M" club, and the athletic editor of the first *Ibis*. Among his other achievements, McGuire had the reputation of being the best "lover" on campus in 1926.⁴⁹ John's mother gave the tribe its first member of Indian lineage: she was a full-blooded Wasach Indian. John's father, like Osceola's father a century earlier, was a Frenchman.

Norman Ted Kennedy was an artist and a violinist in the University's first orchestra. Kennedy wrote the music to UM's first fight song, "Hail to the Spirit," and remembers, "one of my proudest moments was when I was initiated into Iron Arrow."⁵⁰ Kennedy reports that he was given the name "Charlie Big-Bow. I suppose.... because I was a violinist and violist."⁵¹

Clarke Wilson was president of the Student Association in 1927-28, advertising manager for the 1927 *Ibis*, a one-time president of Phi Alpha fraternity, and an effective moderator between warring political factions in the student body.⁵² "Iron Arrow was a serious business with us. I remember the meetings, and we had many of them. I remember Gavin Millar and I were strong for no

⁴⁴ Ibid.

⁴⁵ Ibid.

⁴⁶ Houghtaling repeatedly refers to John McGuire as the first Medicine Man. However, at an Iron Arrow reunion in 1949, which Houghtaling attended, Dale Clark was introduced as the first Medicine Man, with no issue being raised on the matter. Because this date was 25 years closer to 1926, I assign the title to Clark for 1926-27 and to McGuire for 1927-28.





foolishness in initiations, but for impressing the new member with the importance and seriousness of making a real contribution to the University. So, I think, did the other members agree. Though I remember Francis Houghtaling was for a longer, more drawn out initiation ceremony. His idea was to have it on a boat in the Everglades, as I remember. We each selected Indian names for ourselves. I think mine was Chief Stillwaters, but that may not be so.”⁵³

It seems apparent that this name be assigned to Clarke by his fellows in consideration of his role as a moderator in campus disputes. Wilson recalled in a telephone conversation on January 3, 1976, that Houghtaling won out in his desire for an elaborate initiation ceremony, and the ritual was held “beside a rowboat or a skiff along the edge of a body of water somewhere.”⁵⁴

Gavin “Scotty” Millar was president of the Leader’s Club. He was a gymnast and a boxer, a member of the Philosophy Club and the honor Court, and would later serve as president of his senior class and as a member of the Student Senate. His class of 1930 was the first graduating group of students to have spent all four years of their college careers at the University of Miami.

Bob Fink represented Iron Arrow’s desire to be inclusive of all the talents assembled and attendant to the young new University. Among the best of the school’s artists, Fink was accomplished in both design and illustration. The 1927 *Ibis* preserves good examples of his work on pages 18 and 19, which feature the original Spanish architecture envisioned for the University’s Merrick Building. Fink’s father, also an artist, was famous as the illustrator of most of the promotional literature depicting Coral Gables as “the American Riviera.” Fink helped design the shape and dimensions of the original tapping arrow.



⁴⁷ Clark, Dale R., letter to the author, February 16, 1975.

⁴⁸ The 1950 team was undefeated during the regular season (10-0-1), but lost in the Orange Bowl Game to Clemson, 15-14.

⁴⁹ Houghtaling, Francis S., letter to the author, October 27, 1974.

⁵⁰ Kennedy, N. Ted, letter to Rhea Warren, August 10, 1974.

⁵¹ Ibid.

⁵² Millar, Gavin, phone conversation with author, January 3, 1976.





Harry Gray came to Miami from Seattle, Washington. While working part-time at the Miami Herald, Gray also found time to edit the first UM yearbook and work on the student newspaper. His other activities included gymnastics, an elected position in the Leader's Club, and membership in Pi Chi fraternity which later became UM's chapter of Sigma Chi. His associates remember him as witty, bright, and well-liked.⁵³

The tribe's first faculty advisor was Dr. Howard Southgate. The mustachioed professor of drama was directing the University's first stage production, *A Midsummer Night's Dream*, when his student stage manager, Francis Houghtaling, presented him one day with a list of nine names for Iron Arrow. His early college days were spent in New England at Harvard before his graduation from Carnegie Institute. His resumé included directorships in Chicago, Detroit, Lynchburg, Virginia, and "the Petite Theatre du Vieux Carre" in New Orleans.

In the late spring of 1927, a formal petition was drawn up and signed by each of these men "to ask recognition of the honorary society to be known as the Iron Arrow, a clan of the Seminoles." The petition indicated that the "ceremonies and ritual are to be run along Indian lines in highest accord with their ideals." Medicine Man Dale Clark presented the petition to Dr. John F. L. Raschen, Professor of Modern Languages and Chairman of the Committee on Fraternity Activities. Among the qualities delineated as prerequisites for membership, the petition named these five:

1. Candidate must possess the qualifications of a gentleman.
2. Candidate must have maintained average scholarship with not more than one "D".
3. He must be respected and looked up to for his attainment in some school activity.
4. He must be elected by a unanimous vote of the members.
5. Candidate is also judged on his character and potentialities.

The petition closed with the following declaration:

It is with an effort to establish a worthwhile tradition that may be successfully carried on down through the years, and of forming into a group those men who are representative of the spirit of the University in the highest degree, and who will be influential in the life of the institution, that we, the undersigned, ask that 'Iron Arrow' be allowed to take root and grow.

The Committee approved the petition on May 12, 1927.

⁵³ Wilson, Clarke, letter to Rhea Warren, December 29, 1975.

⁵⁴ Ibid.

⁵⁵ Gray's facial features suspiciously resemble those of later Iron Arrow member Joe "Buzz" Schubart, adding additional fuel to speculations that Schubart has been attending the University of Miami since its inception, taking care to alter his alias every 10 to 15 years.





In turning through the brittle, yellowed pages of the first 1927 Ibis, a sense of the laughter and optimism of that era comes alive, the roaring '20s, the moon over Tahiti Beach, and the rustling of the palms. But there has always been a riddle surrounding that first photograph of Iron Arrow. There on page 190 is the picture. Everything seems to be in order. The nine members are wearing their specially made shirts and have already acquired a small tom-tom, which will be in use for at least the next 25 years. The arrow itself apparently had not yet been returned from the foundry in downtown Miami where it was made. As a result, the arrow is depicted in a black and white drawing made by Betty Weakley. Just below this arrow profile, the drawing depicts a Seminole standing in his canoe, poling it into the distance over a bright horizon of water. But the riddle cannot lie overlooked: each of the founding nine is wearing a small, dark mask over his eyes. Why?

The explanation is simple, you say? We thought so, too, at first. Obviously, the members had intended the tribe to be a secret society and were therefore attempting to hide their identities. Perhaps such an explanation could be accepted on the face of it (even if the masks obviously failed in their purpose) if it were not for direct evidence to the contrary.

Turning through the pages of that yearbook, one finds the names and activities of all the students. There, beside the class photo of each Iron Arrow member is a clear, bold listing of his membership in the society. Why, then, do the members wear masks when posing for their tribal pictures? Certainly not out of an attempt to hide their identities from their fellow students.

Again it was Houghtaling who provided the answer; this time to a question he had not even been asked. It was added as an afterthought to other comments. He had been speaking about the tribe's relationship with the Indians: "One thing that they did not like was their pictures taken - hence our masks." How obvious





A RIDDLE

to the student of Indian cultures in North America and yet how enigmatic to an observer 50 years removed. The belief was prevalent in Indian societies that part of the “spirit” of the individual was captured forever by the film, to his detriment when body and spirit must part. In adherence to this Indian belief, the pictures of the society for many years were taken only when masks were worn to conceal the identity of the wearer not from his fellow men, but from the camera.

Iron Arrow member, Larry Catha, wrote the following story in 1974. Catha was the student who “kicked off” the first football in the first football game the University ever played. This is an account of his recollections about the first trip he ever made to South Florida back in 1925.

“December 27, 1925, three men left Kentwood, Louisiana, at 3:30 a.m., Thursday, in a new Ford truck for the far-off magic land of Miami, Florida. The roads were dirt, sand, and a little gravel, so the going was slow as there was plenty of rain. Crossing a ferry at Pearl River, Louisiana, another at Bay Saint Louis, Mississippi, we reached Mobile, Alabama, at 9:30 p.m., just missing the last ferry across Mobile Bay for the day. We spent the night in Mobile. We were the last on the ferry the next morning, but the first off. We met a lot of people on the ferry who were going to Miami. There were three miles of gravel road. Leaving the ferry, the people we met passed us in their Lincolns, Cadillacs, Buicks, etc., and hollered, ‘see you in Miami.’ At the end of the gravel road, they hit the mud. We passed them, and no one passed us again. We drove night and day and arrived in Miami the following Wednesday at 10:30 p.m.

We traveled Highway 90 or the ‘old Spanish Trail.’ There were about 20 toll bridges: Pensacola, Tallahassee, to Madison, where they told us we could go no further as the Suwanee River was on a rampage and was out of its banks for miles. We said we were pioneers and had to get to Miami. We hit the water at 10:30 a.m. and at 3:30 p.m., we had not crossed the bridge, with one driving, and one on each fender with a pole feeling our way along. At this time, we were relieved as a car was coming from the other direction. We knew we could make it if he had. We begged him to turn around and go back, knowing he could not make it in a regular car. Our truck was high, with a special pipe in the exhaust sticking high out of the water. There were times the water was in the cab. He went on. We never heard if he made it or not. The water was at the edge of Live Oak. It was great to be out of it. We spent a few hours getting cleaned up and





TRAVELING TO FLORIDA

eating.

Then on to Lake City, then south to Gainesville, Ocala, and Orlando, east to Indian River City, south on Dixie Highway, a sand and gravel road, West Palm Beach, a small town of several thousand people, Fort Lauderdale, another small town, a one way bridge. The highway was blacktop to Dania, Hollywood, Lemon City, Buena Vista (North Miami now), and Miami.

There were miles of open space between each town. On down Dixie from Miami to Coconut Grove, the millionaires' row including the Deering Estate (Vizcaya), and on to South Miami, a village with one drugstore that sold drugs, Coca-Colas, and ice cream. On to Homestead, the end of travel by car. The only way to Key West was by East Coast R.R.

There were miles of open space between Miami and Coral Gables, which was made up of little villages: Chinese, English, French and, the main part, Spanish. LeJeune Road to the airport was a lonely lover's lane. The Miracle Mile of today was a two-lane road with the Rapid Transit tracks in between meandering through an orange grove to Miami. Venetian Pool was a big coral rock pit where they had dug the rock to build roads. When the town grew up around it, something had to give. Denman Fink, the artist, was hired to beautify it. He came up with the pool idea, with natural clear water coming over the falls.

To get from Miami to Miami Beach, you crossed a one-lane bridge to one causeway. There were seven big hotels on the Beach; The Roney Plaza was the end of the Beach. It was torn down about five years ago. The students from UM used 22nd Street as their beach; no one bothered them. Hialeah was a small town with a racetrack.

In 1926, Miami was called the Magic City because it was growing so fast. Some of the buildings went up too fast. The hurricane of September 17 and 18 brought them down. Flagler Street was a two-way street with a streetcar track in the middle. The population was about 75,000. There was a Seminole Indian village on NW 22nd Street. This is part of the past, you know the present, and who knows the future?"

In the 1927-1928 tapplings, Iron Arrow tapped the first student member who boasted a full-blooded Indian lineage. The student was vocalist George LaMere of the Winnebago Tribe. His Indian name, Hotonka, meant "big voice."⁵⁶

The first Iron Arrow social gathering was held on January 30, 1928, the 90th anniversary of the death of Osceola. "That exclusive organization, the Iron Arrows, threw their first party at the Casa Alegre today. It is rumored that ladies were present.⁵⁷ ...There was dancing with Dale Clark, Clara Nelle DuPuis, and Katie Bostwick furnishing the music. Louise MacCallman told fortunes by cards. Those present were: Katie Bostwick, Dorothy Bostwick, Clara Nelle DuPuis,





Francis ‘Peewee’ Bolton, Louise MacCallman and Marjorie Welch. The Iron Arrows present were: Harry Gray, Leonard Tuttle, Dale Clark, Ted Kennedy, Bob Fink, Gavin Millar, Francis Houghtaling and Clarke Wilson.”⁵⁸

Iron Arrow member, Larry Catha, tells the story of how the University’s athletic teams first became known as the Hurricanes. “‘Cub’ Buck was the first coach, and the team went undefeated the first year. I had the honor of kicking off the first football in the first game. We were on the practice field trying to get a name for the team. A boy came out on a motorcycle and told us to hurry home as another hurricane was on its way. Getting on the bus, Porter Norris said, ‘let us be the Hurricanes.’”⁵⁹

Any history or story dealing with origins must concern itself with dates. Francis Houghtaling provides us with those dates important to Iron Arrow. “I met Dr. B. F. Ashe in the physics laboratory of Dr. O. P. Hart on November 11, 1926.”⁶⁰ This would have been a Thursday afternoon and would thus have placed the founding of Iron Arrow within one month of the time the University first opened its doors (Friday, October 15). “Howard Southgate and I met for the first time on November 15, 1926.”⁶¹ This would have been the next Monday morning. “The founding nine met in Howard Southgate’s office in the NE corner of the auditorium on November 19, 1926”⁶² the first meeting in Iron Arrow history.





BITS AND PIECES

⁵⁶ The Miami Hurricane, January 6, 1938, and Spofford Scrapbook, 1927-28, University of Miami Archives.

⁵⁷ Ibis, 1928

⁵⁸ The University News, February 2, 1928.

⁵⁹ Catha, Larry, letter to Rhea Warren, July 11, 1975.

⁶⁰ Houghtaling, Francis S., letter to Rhea Warren, July 11, 1975.

⁶¹ Ibid.

⁶² Ibid.





A PERSONAL HISTORY OF THE EARLY YEARS

The History of UM as Lived by Audrey Rothenberg - 1934-1938

I arrived at 624 Santander (the women's dorm which housed 34) and was greeted by Mom and Pop Koch - house parents. Living there was real "in loco parentis" - you signed in, signed out. If you were late, you were grounded. You needed a letter of permission to stay away - like a weekend at a friend's house. (The number of women living there grew to 64 by the time I graduated.)

I entered the Cardboard College on September 24, 1934. This was the facility which replaced the grand, luxurious plans for a spectacular University of Miami which collapsed along with the financial bust of the country getting only so far as the skeleton of what's now the Merrick building.

The walls really were cardboard; the third floor really was unfinished; the outer walls really were a mess. I really was one of those who got on a ladder and painted the building. The existence of the University of Miami is due to Dr. Ashe's refusal to give up his dream, even using his own insurance money when in a bind.

Being part of a young, growing institution gives one the opportunity to be a pioneer - to help form traditions. I was so privileged. I helped to found Nu Kappa Tau, the Women's honorary, later to become Mortar Board. I helped to create a Jewish sorority which we named Theta Chi Omega. It was sponsored by Alpha Epsilon Phi and became the Alpha Eta chapter of AEPhi. I was the charter president. I wrote for the Hurricane, edited the Ibis and was president of Panhellenic. When I graduated, cum laude, Dr. Ashe asked me to stay and be his executive secretary, but I was chicken and went back to Savannah.

I can attest to the fact that "love of alma mater" is a life long thing because upon moving to Coral Gables in 1951, I resumed my interest and involvement - continuing to this moment.⁶³



⁶³ Personal reflections of Audrey Rothenberg Finkelstein.

